assault teams fell back, there was a heavy exchange of fire at the Trijunction perimeter, during which two Kumaonis were killed while both Bhatia and Khatri along with another jawan were wounded. After an hour and a half of bitter fighting, there was a lull as the Chinese withdrew to reorganize themselves.

At 7.30 a.m., the Chinese attacked again. This did not amount to much even though there were casualties on both sides. Throughout the day, the Chinese kept shelling Trijunction intermittently. Despite that, the Kumaonis numbers at Trijunction swelled considerably as small scattered parties managed to return to base. Most of the wounded had been pulled into Trijunction as well, and the Medical Platoon under the RMO, Captain B. C. Chopra, was treating the severely injured. The walking wounded were given basic medical treatment and sent back to man the defences.

Even though the Chinese had succeeded in laying ambushes along the line of communication between Trijunction and Mortar Post, Subedar Ganga Singh, the officiating subedar major, arrived at Trijunction with some ammunition and, equally importantly, cooked food for the men. Two puris were allocated to each man. It would be the last cooked meal that they would get to eat in the Walong Sector.

As darkness fell on Walong, the defenders could see the flashes of gunfire from various other posts in the Lohit Valley below them. However, almost on cue, Chinese artillery began to bracket the Trijunction defences with extremely accurate fire. The Chinese had constructed an elevated observation post approximately 180 metres away from the Kumaonis main defences. Three Chinese soldiers were occupying the post. Havildar Pushkar Singh, known for his accurate shooting, successfully dropped all three. Almost immediately, the shelling died down.

After a brief lull, the Chinese launched another determined attack. Just as the Kumaonis had found it impossible to make any headway against the Chinese defences on Yellow Pimple, the Chinese too were unable to force their way into Trijunction. The first attack was dispersed, only to be followed by a second wave of advancing Chinese that was repulsed as well. Bhatia reported to Madiah that the surviving Chinese troops had gone to ground and were using their own dead as defensive shields. The Indian casualties were also mounting. Madiah once again spoke to Brigade HQ only to be told that 4 Dogra was on its way, but had been held up as the